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„Worshiping Siva
and Buddha„



THE TEMPLE ART
OF EAST JAVA

Ann R. Kinney

WITH Marijke J. Klokke

Lydia Kieven

PHOTOGRAPHS BY Rio Helmi



University of Hawai'i Press
Honolulu

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To S.D., who introduced me to Indonesia

and

Governor and Mrs. Mohammed Noer, our hosts in East Java

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Page 2: Rampant lions at the corners of Candi Kidal, East Java,
Malang district, Candi Kidal, 13th century (see fig. 49).

Page 3: *Bhuta* messenger rushes past a *candi*, *Ramayana* relief 20,
East Java, Blitar district, Candi Panataran, c. 1323-47 (see fig. 149).

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CANDI JOLOTUNDO

Homage to King Udayana's Ancestors

The majestic bathing place, Jolotundo, was founded in 977, half a century after King Sindok (ruled 929–47) came to power and established his East Javanese kingdom. The structure of the bathing place represents a stylistic and architectural break from the conventions of Central Javanese monuments.

The founders of Jolotundo chose the western slope of Mount Penanggungan to build this important monument in honor of the Pandawa ancestors of the Indian King Udayana. The historic Udayana, who fathered East Java's famous King Airlangga, lived at the time of Jolotundo's founding and likely had a connection to the bathing place.¹ Mountains have long been central to Javanese religion and culture and are often the sites of religious sanctuaries. They provide the rich alluvial soil for Java's rice culture and periodically unleash enormously destructive volcanic eruptions and floods. They are the abodes of the countless mountain, rock, and tree spirits of Java's animistic beliefs, melding animism with Buddhist beliefs concerning the Cosmic Mountain and the creative and destructive forces of Hinduism.

Mount Penanggungan, which rises to a height of 1653 meters between Surabaya and Malang, was revered as sacred during the period of Hindu ascendancy in East Java. According to Hindu Javanese mythology, the gods were carrying Mahameru, the World Mountain, from India to Java when the top of the mountain and eight auxiliary peaks broke off and fell to the ground, forming Mount Penanggungan. The remainder of the mountain was deposited to the east, forming Mount Semeru, Java's highest mountain. Eighty-one terraced sanctuaries, altars, hermitages, and *candis*, dating from the tenth through the early sixteenth century, were built on the slopes of Mount Penanggungan. These sites fall into two groups: a few early sites such as the bathing places Jolotundo (977) and Belahan (1049),

Fig. 10
Jolotundo bathing place
East Java, Mojokerto district, 977
Andesite

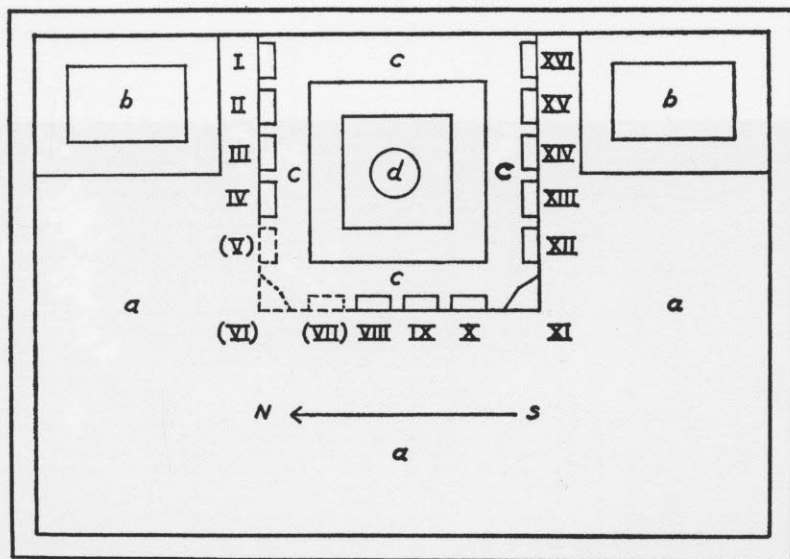


Fig. 11

Plan of the bathing place

a. main basin; b. small walled-in basins;
c. central terrace; d. *lingga* fountain;

I-XVI, spouts with reliefs

Source: Bosch 1961, p. 50

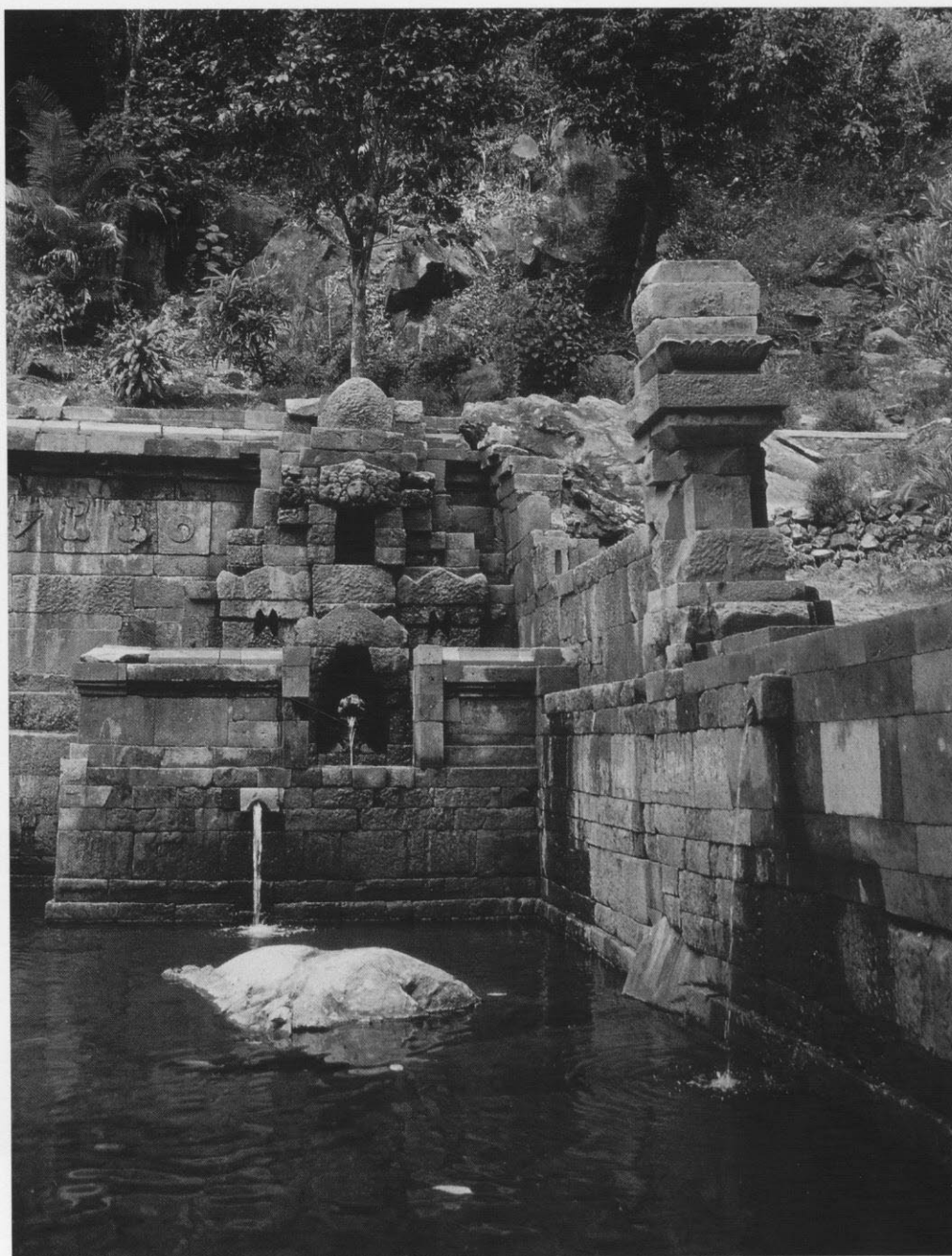
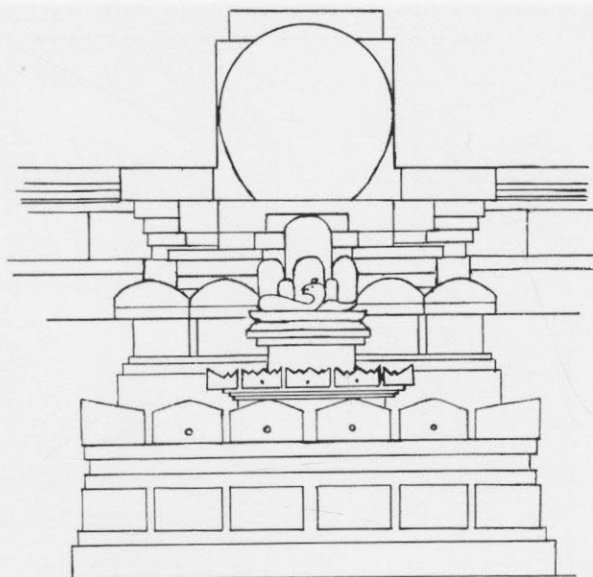


Fig. 12

Right-hand section of the bathing place showing the naga spout

East Java, Mojokerto district,
Candi Jolotundo, 977

Fig. 13
Elevation of the central terrace
 East Java, Mojokerto district,
 Candi Jolotundo, 977
 Source: Bosch 1965, 197



commemorating East Javanese kings of the time; and many other mountain sanctuaries dating from the mid-fourteenth to the early sixteenth century. These later sites were rediscovered only between 1930 and 1940, and some are difficult to visit.² During the British interregnum (1811–16), when Holland had been incorporated into France, Sir Stamford Raffles was appointed Lieutenant Governor, replacing the Dutch administrator. Raffles extended British control over the Dutch East Indies. He was an able administrator who, besides reforming some aspects of the colonial administration, produced the two-volume *The History of Java*, published in 1817.

Ensign J.W.B. Wardenaar, whom Raffles had charged to examine and sketch the monuments of the Majapahit kingdom, made the first European discovery of Jolotundo in 1815. Wardenaar left no written description of the site, though he did make a not-very-accurate drawing of the central basin. Here is a description of Jolotundo as it was in 1840:

“In centuries gone by, the fountain must have been a paragon of lofty architecture, not because of its extraordinary size, but because of the massiveness of its parts, its majestic proportions and noble style. . . . Against a steep slope, a spring was to be found . . . in the middle of a rock face. This rock face was given a most beautiful architonic aspect in the shape of a massive balustrade, from which two wings project, embracing an enormous basin. From the back-wall three separate baths jut out independently. The main basin consists of one large basin and two smaller ones.”³

The description mentions the existence of reliefs and “serpents spouting water into the main basin” but little other information regarding ornamentation.

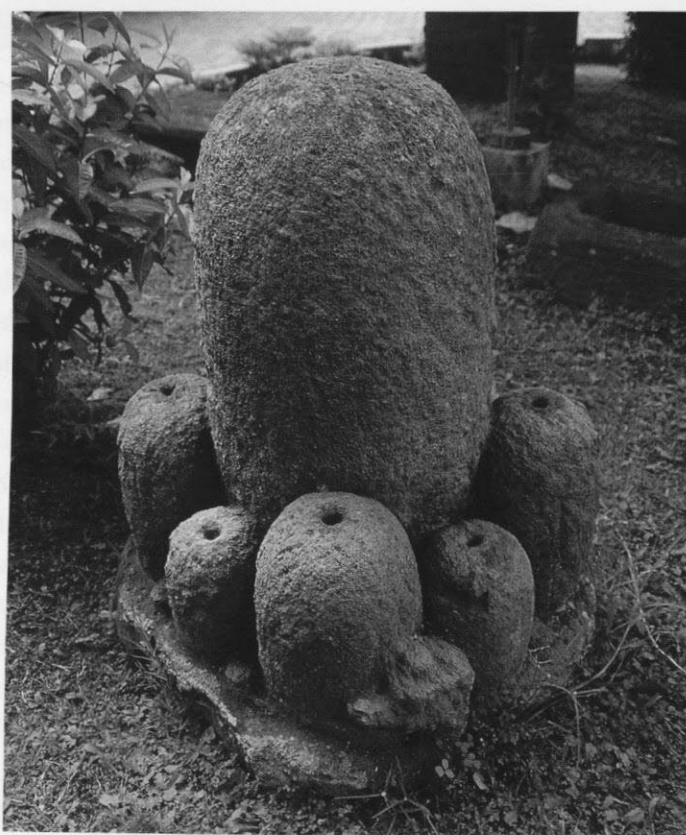


Fig. 14
Lingga fountain sculpture from Jolotundo
 East Java, Mojokerto district, Candi Jolotundo, 977
 Volcanic stone, h. 1.19 m
 Archaeological Office, Trowulan

The site was neglected and suffered further damage from both nature and man until 1921–23, when the Netherlands East Indies Archaeological Service carried out as thorough a restoration as was possible given the existing remains. Thanks to the work of B. de Haan of the Archaeological Service and research by W.F. Stutterheim⁴ and F.D.K. Bosch,⁵ we now know the sequence of the reliefs and the stories depicted in them.⁶ We also have a plausible motive for the foundation of this important monument.

Figure 11 shows the plan of Jolotundo, a rectangular basin sixteen by thirteen meters, facing west. The basin is enclosed by walls on all four sides, with a back wall of five meters. The sidewalls with turrets at the corners descend stepwise to the present low front wall, which originally was likely a higher balustrade with outlets for the water to flow down the mountain. In the northeast and southeast corners are two smaller basins fed by spouts in the form of a Garuda on the left and a *naga* on the right. A five-meters-square elevated terrace attached to the center of the back wall extends out into the main basin. This terrace formed a stepped-pyramid-shaped base for a fountain formed by nine *lingga*-like pillars encircled by a snake. This fountain sculpture may now be seen on the grounds of the Archaeological Service's office in Trowulan. An ingenious system fed water from the back wall up through channels in the nine *lingga*-like columns, from whence the water flowed into the main basin through a series of spouts decorated with some of the sixteen reliefs indicated by the roman numerals in figure 11.

Figure 13 shows the elevation of the central terrace with the stone blocks for the reliefs shaped as rectangles topped by obtuse triangles and pierced by spouts. The *lingga*-like fountain rests on the base and the rear wall is crowned with a monumental oval cornice. The back wall is austere, its plain surface formed by rectangular blocks interrupted only by the oval cornice and two inscriptions, *Saka* 899 (equivalent to 977 C.E.) to the south, and the untranslated *gempeng* to the north. The oval cornice formed the backslab for a central figure placed on the thronelike base above and behind the fountain top-piece. Garuda and *naga* fountains on the same level at each side of the bathing place suggest that the central figure was Vishnu flanked by his two consorts. No trace has been found of these sculptures and it is possible that they were never completed.

The religious significance of water is central to all bathing places but particularly to Jolotundo, located as it is on a slope of Mount Penanggungan, representing Mount Meru, the Cosmic Mountain. Hindus believe that the holy mountain is the container for *amerta*, the elixir of immortality, which here flows from the mountain into the bathing place of Jolotundo via the snake-encircled central fountain, mimicking Mount Meru churned by the World Snake. The holy water revives the spirits of the legendary Pandawa ancestors of Javanese kings depicted in the reliefs, and flows from the bathing place to enrich the lives of the people.

Sixteen reliefs were installed around the central terrace, starting at the northeast corner. Numbers I, II, III, and IV remain at the site and XVI is at the Trowulan Museum. Reliefs IX, X, XI, XIII, XIV, XV, the finial from one of the turrets, and a reliquary urn are on display in the National Museum in Jakarta. Reliefs VIII and XII are severely abraded and not on view. No trace of Reliefs V, VI, and VII has been found. All the reliefs except for the missing three were photographed at the time of the 1920s restoration.

Prior to the restoration, the reliefs had been set along the outer wall of the main basin and visitors to the site assumed that this was their original location.



However, in the course of restoration the archaeologists matched the legs of a figure in Relief XVI with a pair of feet carved on the southeast corner of the central terrace. Among the debris surrounding the central terrace, numerous heads, arms, and other parts of the vandalized reliefs were found seemingly just below their original placement. The inscription *Udayana* was carved under the newly relocated Relief XVI depicting a man with a bow-shaped harp. This figure was recognized as the legendary Indian King Udayana who, according to the *Adiparwa*, the first book of the *Mahabharata*, and in a collection of tales called the *Kathasaritsagara*, was an accomplished harp player and the namesake of the Balinese King Udayana who fathered Java's King Airlangga.⁷ During the reconstruction, a stone bearing the inscription *Mergawati* in Old Javanese was found belonging just to the left of the Udayana inscription. Reliefs XIV, XV, and XVI were associated with the tenth chapter of the *Kathasaritsagara* stories.

Relief XIV illustrates the story of the heavenly nymph Tilottama's curse on the union of Sahasranika and Mergawati. King Sahasranika, a Pandawa descendant of Arjuna, was told by the god Indra that he was destined to marry Mergawati, daughter of the king of Ayodhya. The king immediately proceeded to search for her in the chariot lent him by the god Indra. As the king was leaving, Tilottama, who had fallen in love with him, tried to speak to him but the king paid no attention and departed in haste. The enraged Tilottama invoked a curse that the royal couple would be separated for fourteen years. In this relief we see the double-roofed palace of Indra under a large spreading tree to the left. Tilottama, uttering her curse, is walking to the right toward the royal couple Sahasranika and Mergawati, who hold hands.

Relief XV continues the story of Sahasranika and Mergawati. During her pregnancy, the queen developed a craving to bathe in a pond filled with blood. Hoping to satisfy her, the king had the water in a pond dyed red, which turned the bathing queen red herself. This attracted the attention of a large Garuda, who swooped down and plucked her out of the pond thinking she was a piece of meat. The Garuda realized his mistake and dropped her on the top of a mountain, where

FIG. 15
Relief XIV: Tilottama cursing Sahasranika and Mergawati
East Java, Mojokerto district, Candi Jolotundo, 977
Andesite, h. 34 cm
National Museum, Jakarta



FIG. 16
Relief XV: The abduction of Mergawati by a Garuda
 East Java, Mojokerto district, Candi Jolotundo, 977
 Andesite, h. 55 cm
 National Museum, Jakarta

she was found and taken to a hermitage. Soon after she gave birth to a son, Udayana, who was destined to rule as king. Sahasranika then learned of Tilottama's curse to separate him from his queen. The relief illustrates the episodes of this story, as we see the king to the left stretching his arms toward the Garuda and his queen. On the right are two small houses and the hermit's cave that served as the refuge for her and her soon-to-be-born son, Udayana. The H-shaped motifs above the Garuda represent clouds.

Relief XVI tells the story of the young Udayana, who grew up among the hermits who sheltered Mergawati after her abduction. One day he was hunting in the forest when he met a forester who had captured a snake. Feeling sorry for the snake, Udayana ordered the forester to release it. The forester protested, saying he was a poor man who made his living by exhibiting dancing snakes. Udayana gave the forester a bracelet engraved with his father's name in exchange for the snake's release. To show his gratitude, the snake gave Udayana a harp. When the forester tried to sell the bracelet in the marketplace, he was arrested and brought before King Sahasranika. The forester told of his meeting with Udayana, whereupon a heavenly voice announced that Tilottama's curse had run its course and that Queen Mergawati and Udayana resided in a forest hermitage. The king hastened to the hermitage and the royal family was reunited after the predicted separation of fourteen years.

In the left half of this relief, which is the only part that survives, we see Udayana, dressed in a loincloth and holding a bow-shaped harp, standing next to the forester, who is the small deformed man to the right. The snake would probably have been shown on the bottom portion of the relief that is now missing. The background consists of a rocky wall and a spreading tree, which often divides such



FIG. 17

Relief XVI: The meeting of Udayana and a forester

East Java, Mojokerto district, Candi Jolotundo, 977
Andesite, h. 35 cm
Trowulan Museum

panels into two story sections. The tree is truncated in a line with the apex of the triangle, indicating that the right section of this relief is missing.

The remaining reliefs depict important episodes in the lives of leading members of the Pandawa clan in the nine or ten generations preceding the life of the Indian Udayana. It has been proposed that the reliefs represent the ancestors of Udayana in the following order: Palasara, Vyasa, Pandu, Arjuna, Abhimanyu, Pariksit, Janamejaya, Sahasranika, and Udayana.⁸ The lineage starts with the great-grandfather of Arjuna and ends with Udayana, the great-grandson or great-great-grandson of Arjuna's grandson, Pariksit. Whatever the connection of the *Mahabharata*'s Udayana with the historic Balinese prince, the reliefs support the belief that the Pandawas were among the legendary ancestors of Javanese kings. Their presence here serves to sanctify Jolotundo and legitimize the rulers of East Java.

The first four reliefs can be seen on the northeast corner of the central terrace at Jolotundo; they are not in good condition. To the right on Relief I the ascetic Palasara sits meditating with his hands crossed in front of his chest. The god Bhatar Bayu is pulling him roughly in an attempt to disturb his meditation. Relief II depicts the meeting in a rocky forest hermitage of the god Narada, in the central nimbus, with Palasara, the meditating person sitting to the right of him. In Relief III the meditating Palasara sits to the right and the god Bhatar Brahma surrounded by flames sits to the left, trying to interfere with Palasara's meditation.

Meditation was central to the practice of both Hinduism and Buddhism. In Old Javanese literature there are many stories in which protagonists meditate and others attempt to disturb them. This tests the seriousness of the individual meditating or gauges the ties that he still has to the physical world.⁹ The purpose of breaking the individual's meditation is often to regain his services and help with a

temporal problem. Bathing places such as Jolotundo and Belahan are located at mountain sites that have long attracted devotees of meditation, and it is not surprising that a number of the reliefs at Jolotundo feature meditation.

The now-missing left-hand section of Relief IV showed how Palasara was forced to end his meditation. Palasara was depicted in a yoga position with two birds, actually the gods Bhatara Guru and Narada in disguise, perched on his head to disturb him. The impertinence of the birds irritated Palasara and broke his meditation. The right section of the relief at the site shows Palasara meeting Satyawati, the daughter of the Indian king Uparicara. Satyawati was born of a fish and gave off such a disagreeable odor that her father banished her and put her in the care of a fisherman. One day, as she was steering a ferryboat across a river, she met Palasara, who fell in love with her and fathered her son, Krishna Dwaipayana. Palasara is the same Brahmin who was the legendary author of the Vedas and the father of Pandu, the forefather of the Pandawas. Pandu, who ruled on behalf of his brother, the blind king of the Korawas, fathered the *Mahabharata* heroes, Yudhishtira, Bhima, Arjuna, and the twins Nakula and Sadewa. After Pandu's death, the Korawa forced the Pandawa clan into a lengthy exile. On the right-hand section of Relief IV we see Satyawati standing in her boat to the right with Palasara in the center.

Reliefs IX, X, and XIII in the Jakarta National Museum are well preserved and describe more familiar episodes from the *Mahabharata*. One of the most famous stories tells of the *swayamwara*, an archery contest held to win the hand of Princess Drupadi and attended by the exiled Pandawa brothers. In Relief IX we see on the left Yudhishtira, Bhima, and the twins disguised as princes, watching Arjuna, the figure in the center holding his bow, which he has succeeded in bending after other suitors failed. To the right we see Drupada, the father of Princess Drupadi, seated on a throne with an oval back and the princess seated in the right foreground with her disappointed suitors behind her.

Relief X presents the action-filled aftermath of the betrothal with an energetic Bhima occupying center stage. We easily recognize Bhima from his large genitals. Bhima has uprooted a tree to use as a weapon in the Pandawa brothers' fight with the suitors rejected by Princess Drupadi. Arjuna is in the extreme upper left with a bow in his upraised left hand. To the right are the three Pandawa brothers, Yudhishtira with sword in hand, and the twins Nakula and Sadewa, who left prior to the fight. Servants at the extreme right are carrying their mother, Kunti.

Relief XIII is the remaining relief in good enough condition to have artistic merit. It tells the story of the serpent sacrifice made by Janamejaya to avenge the death of his father Pariksit depicted in Relief XII.¹⁰ The *naga* king had killed Janamejaya's father because he was offended by Pariksit's abuse of a hermit. In Relief XIII, Janamejaya is seated at the left with a Brahmin presumably planning the serpent sacrifice, which is shown to the right of the tree. Two snakes are entwined above the fire on an altar to the right of a priest conducting the ceremony.

The form and style of the Jolotundo reliefs are very different from the narrative art of Central Java. With their fleshy bodies and natural proportions, the figures in Central Javanese reliefs at Prambanan and Borobudur reflect Indian models. In contrast, the Jolotundo figures are willowy or even sinuous, with large heads in relation to elongated arms and bodies. The settings and attire of the figures lack the royal pomp and regalia of the scenes in Central Java. The figures are dressed simply in *sarongs* with virtually no jewelry, and exhibit a variety of Javanese hairstyles in

place of regal crowns. Their mood is informal and the presentation of the figures is expressive and active. The attitude of the figures, which are shown full face, in profile, in three-quarter view, or from the rear, is natural and very mobile. The settings are simple and, with the exception of stylized spirals of rockery, naturalistic.

The rectangular shape of the stones with their triangular caps dictates the composition of the reliefs. Stylized rockery forms the base of most panels and the background of a few. Each panel usually depicts two or more episodes of the story being told. The division between these synoptic scenes may be indicated by a tree in the center of the panel with luxuriant tropical foliage spreading over both scenes; a building, which provides the setting for a new scene; or a standing or seated figure. The carving of these reliefs is deep; many of the figures are carved almost in the round. The volcanic stone used for the construction of Jolotundo is brittle and rather porous, presenting a challenge to the artisans. Jolotundo sculptors seem to anticipate in stone the plastic terracotta figures that embellished East Javanese architecture during the Majapahit period. By incorporating local popular idioms of artistic expression into the architecture of a sanctuary honoring the ruling house, Jolotundo marks a break with the traditions of Central Java and constitutes a strong statement of indigenous East Javanese culture.

Javanese sanctuaries were constructed to fulfill a number of religious needs. Some provided a conducive setting for meditation; others housed a religious order or provided a place for the conduct of religious ceremonies. Bathing places served as containers for holy water or basins for cleansing rituals. During the East Javanese period, ancient traditions of ancestor worship melded with the contemporary practice of deifying deceased kings and worshipping them in combination with a Hindu or Buddhist god. In the strict sense of the word, *candi* refers to the monuments constructed for the worship of deified kings. Candis Jago, Jawi, Singosari, Rimbi, Jabung, Tigowangi, and Surowono are East Javanese examples. The thirteenth through fifteenth centuries were a period of East Javanese ascendancy during which the system of governance was solidified and these monuments proliferated.

Until recently, it was assumed that these monuments also provided the burial site for the ashes of the person honored.¹¹ Ensign Wardenaar unearthed a stone urn with nine compartments containing ashes and small golden plates at Jolotundo. This urn can be seen in the National Museum in Jakarta. However, research by Prof. R. Soekmono, the late head of the Indonesian Archaeological Service, indicates that these monuments did not serve as burial sites.¹² No references to *candis* as funerary monuments have been found in inscriptions and literary works of the period. A review of Balinese religious practices, which are a guide to Hindu-Javanese customs operative before the spread of Islam in Java, has likewise produced no evidence that *candis* provided resting places for the ashes of the deceased. The urns or caskets found under the bases of monuments during excavation are

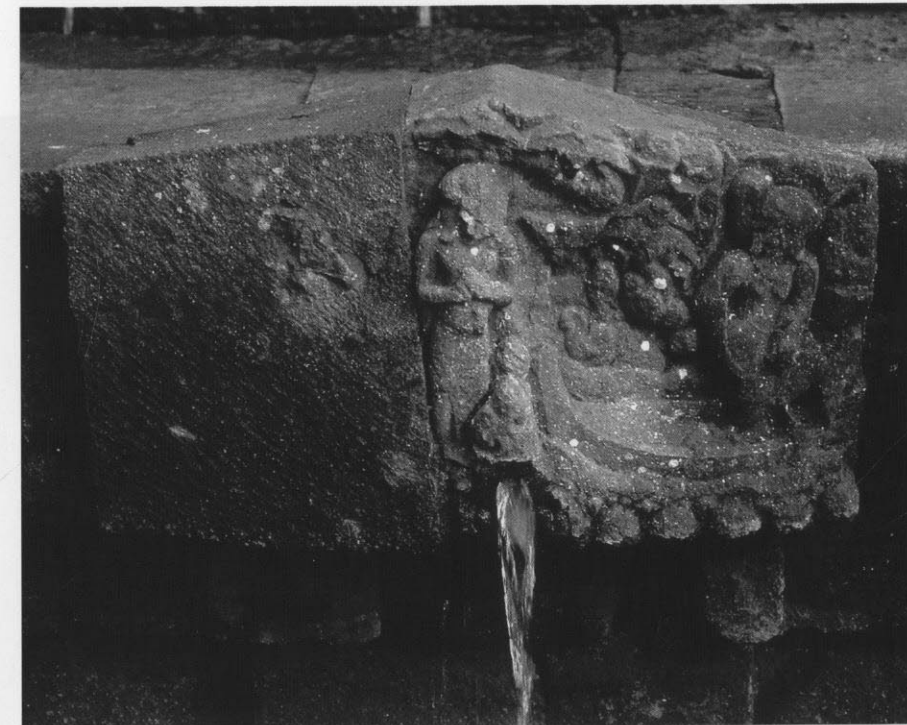


FIG. 18
Relief IV: Right-hand section, Satyawati meeting Palasara
East Java, Mojokerto district, Candi Jolotundo, 977
Andesite, h. 51 cm



FIG. 19
Relief IX: The swayamwara (betrothal)
of Drupadi
East Java, Mojokerto district, Candi Jolotundo, 977
Andesite, h. 32 cm
National Museum, Jakarta



FIG. 20
Relief X: Bhima and Arjuna fighting the
rejected suitors of Drupadi
East Java, Mojokerto district, Candi Jolotundo, 977
Andesite, h. 60 cm
National Museum, Jakarta



FIG. 21
Relief XIII: The serpent sacrifice of
Janamejaya
East Java, Mojokerto district, Candi Jolotundo, 977
Andesite, h. 30 cm
National Museum, Jakarta

instead *peripih*s, reliquaries containing inscriptions and objects of religious significance. In some cases several *peripih*s have been found located around the perimeter of a *candi* base and temple complex as well as under the center *cella* of the *candi*.

This new interpretation has helped explain the foundation of Jolotundo. It had long been assumed that there was a connection between the legendary Pandawa descendant, Udayana, and the historic Balinese King Udayana, the father of East Java's King Airlangga, but it was difficult chronologically to connect the historic King Udayana with the bathing place at Jolotundo. Jolotundo was founded in the year 977, and Udayana was likely born in 963 and reigned over Bali with his Javanese princess Mahendradatta during the years 989 to 1001. It is not likely that Jolotundo was intended as Udayana's burial site as he was only about fourteen years old and had yet to achieve political prominence when Jolotundo was constructed. Because many of the reliefs at Jolotundo depict betrothals and marriages of the Pandawas, there has been speculation that Jolotundo celebrated Udayana's betrothal to the Javanese princess Mahendradatta.¹³ The unfinished stones bordering the base of the platform for the missing central statue may have been intended to depict future exploits of the historic Udayana. Whatever the motive for the founding of Jolotundo, it is clear that the historic Udayana had a close connection to this monument and that East Java's rulers were intentionally linked to their illustrious Pandawa ancestors at this beautiful mountain sanctuary.



FIG. 22
Nine-compartment peripih reliquary
East Java, Mojokerto district,
Candi Jolotundo, 977
Andesite, h. 43 cm, d. 50 cm
National Museum, Jakarta

Candi Jolotundo:

Location: Desa Seloliman, Kecamatan Trawas, Kabupaten Mojokerto
Orientation: faces west
Dimensions: 16.85 meters wide, 13.52 meters long, 5.2 meters high
Materials: brick and andesite blocks

Notes

1. See the last paragraph of this chapter for a discussion of the connection of the historic Udayana to Jolotundo.
2. The later sites are discussed in the chapter "Mountain Sites at the Twilight of Majapahit."
3. For Sieburgh's report on an 1840 visit, see Bosch and de Haan 1965, 203.
4. Stutterheim 1937, 212–50.
5. Bosch 1961, 50–107. See also Bosch and de Haan 1965, 189–232.
6. A later restoration carried out by the Indonesian Archaeological Service in the early 1990s restored the water works and is responsible for the excellent state of the bathing place today.
7. Bosch deserves credit for linking the Jolotundo reliefs to episodes of the *Adiparwa*. Thanks to his knowledge of Indian epics, he was able to reconstruct the sequence of the reliefs and associate them with the historic Udayana. His explanations are generally accepted.
8. Bosch 1961, 60–86.
9. The most famous examples are the many surviving depictions of the nymphs' efforts to disturb the meditation of Arjuna as related in the *Arjuna Wiwaha*.
10. Relief XII is not on display but is illustrated in the photo addendum accompanying Bosch 1961.
11. Soekmono 1995, 1–5.
12. Ibid.
13. Bosch 1961, 100.